₹15,000
CRORE
Expected size of Indian drone market by 2026

100,000
Requirement for drone pilots in India by 2024



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FLY AND DELIVER

DELIVERY DRONES HOLD A LOT OF PROMISE FOR BOTH URBAN INDIA AND THE RURAL HINTERLAND

By AJAY SUKUMARAN

In 2013, when Amazon founder Jeff Bezos first spoke of plans to deliver packages using drones, he insisted that it wasn't science fiction. In December last year, the e-commerce giant announced its first drone deliveries, although these were on a small scale, catering to only two towns in the US. In just a decade, however, delivery by drone has gone from being an idea up in the air to something that could transform the world of logistics. The American firm Zipline, for instance, says its drones have clocked over 700,000 deliveries ferrying 7.33 million items, making it the world's largest drone logistics company. Founded in 2014, Zipline started by delivering blood and medical products in Rwanda in 2016 before expanding to food, retail, agricultural and animal health products. Then, just this month, the UK's Royal Mail announced a daily mail distribution service by drone to some remote islands off Scotland.